SIGHTLINE SCHEMATIC · STEP-BY-STEP GUIDE 1 OF 3

SketchUp: import the bowl mass

Download the SketchUp model and import it into SketchUp to create the bowl mass.

YOU NEED

- SketchUp Pro desktop (2017 or later)
- The bowl you want, open in Sightline Schematic

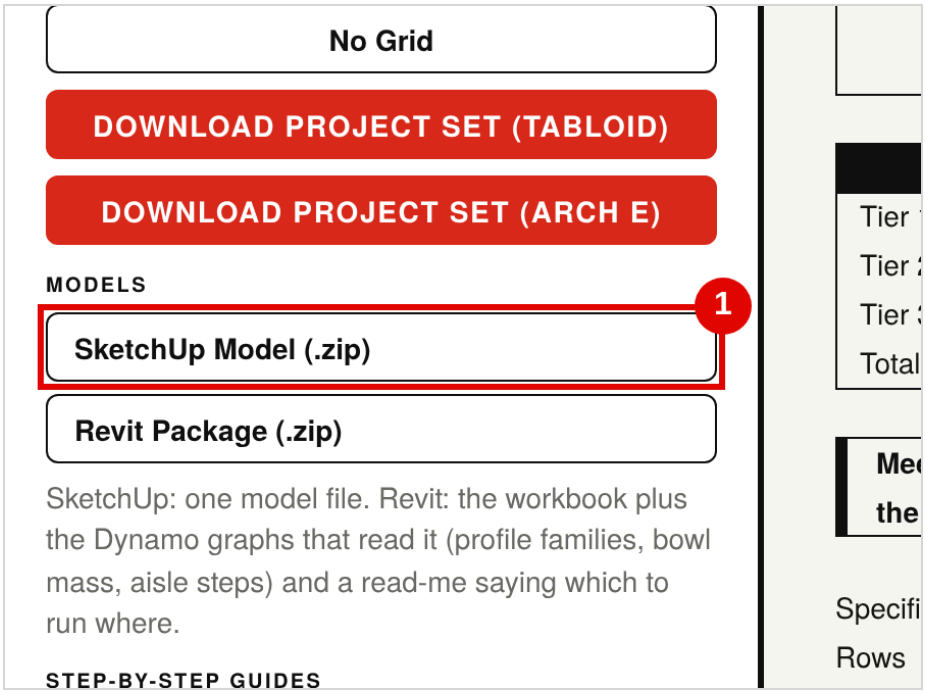
YOU GET

- The whole bowl as closed solids, one per stand (tier and side)
- Precast aisle steps as components, and the pitch
- True size, in metres, origin at the field centre

STEPS

1 Download the SketchUp model

In Sightline Schematic, scroll to **Deliver** and, under **Models**, click **SketchUp model (.zip)**. The browser saves `Stadium_Bowl_Mass_Sketchup.zip`.



Deliver › Models. (1) SketchUp model (.zip): one model file of the current bowl.

2 Unzip it

Right-click the zip and choose **Extract All** (Windows) or double-click it (Mac). SketchUp cannot import from inside a zip.

Stadium_Bowl_Mass_Sketchup.zip		
DAE	**Stadium_Bowl_Mass_Sketchup.dae**	the model (COLLADA)
TXT	**How to open in SketchUp.txt**	short version of this guide
PDF	**Stadium_Bowl_Mass_Sketchup_Guide.pdf**	this guide

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3 Open or start a SketchUp model

Open the model the bowl belongs in, or start a new one from a template in metres or feet and inches (either works: the file carries its own units, so it imports at true size).

> To keep the bowl on the model origin, start with nothing selected and the drawing axes in their default place.

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4 Import the .dae file

File › **Import…**

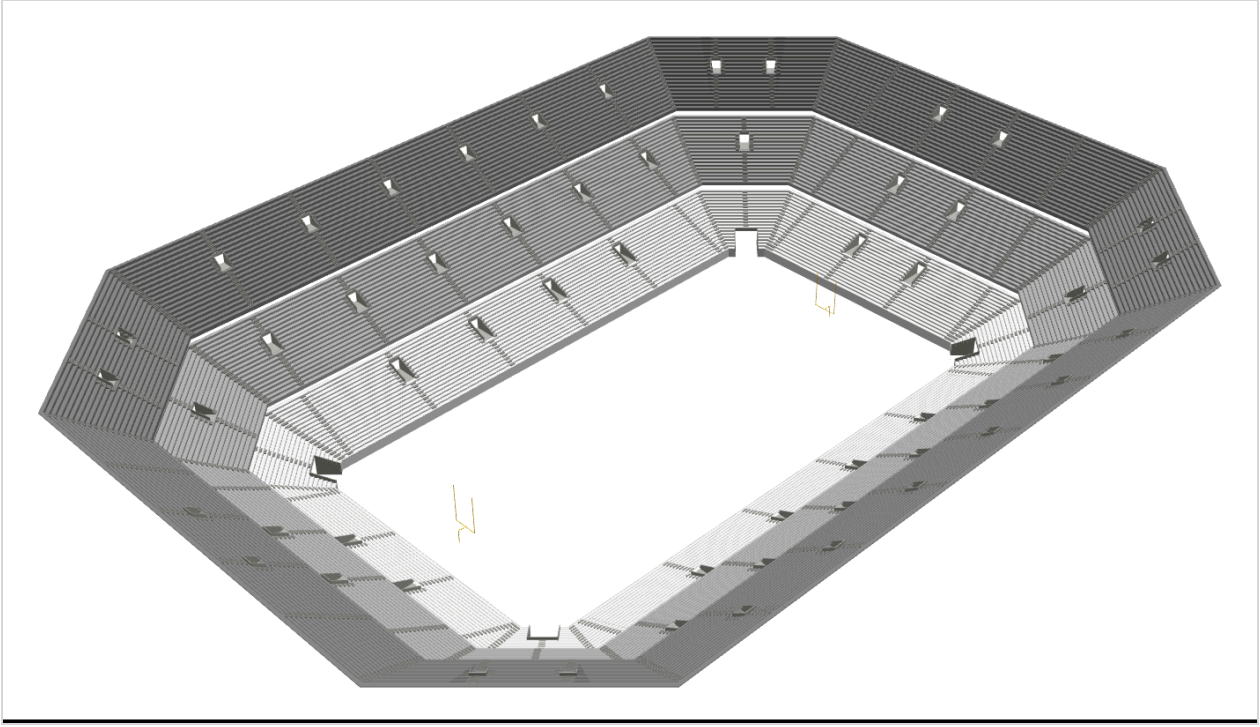
1. In the file type list at the bottom of the dialog, choose **COLLADA File (*.dae)**.
2. Click **Options…**: tick **Preserve drawing origin** if your version offers it, and leave **Merge coplanar faces** off so every tread and riser stays a clean face. Click **OK**.
3. Pick **Stadium_Bowl_Mass_Sketchup.dae** and click **Import**.
4. If the bowl arrives on the cursor, click on the origin (where the red, green and blue axes meet) to drop it there.

The model is large: a full bowl with aisle steps can take a minute to import.

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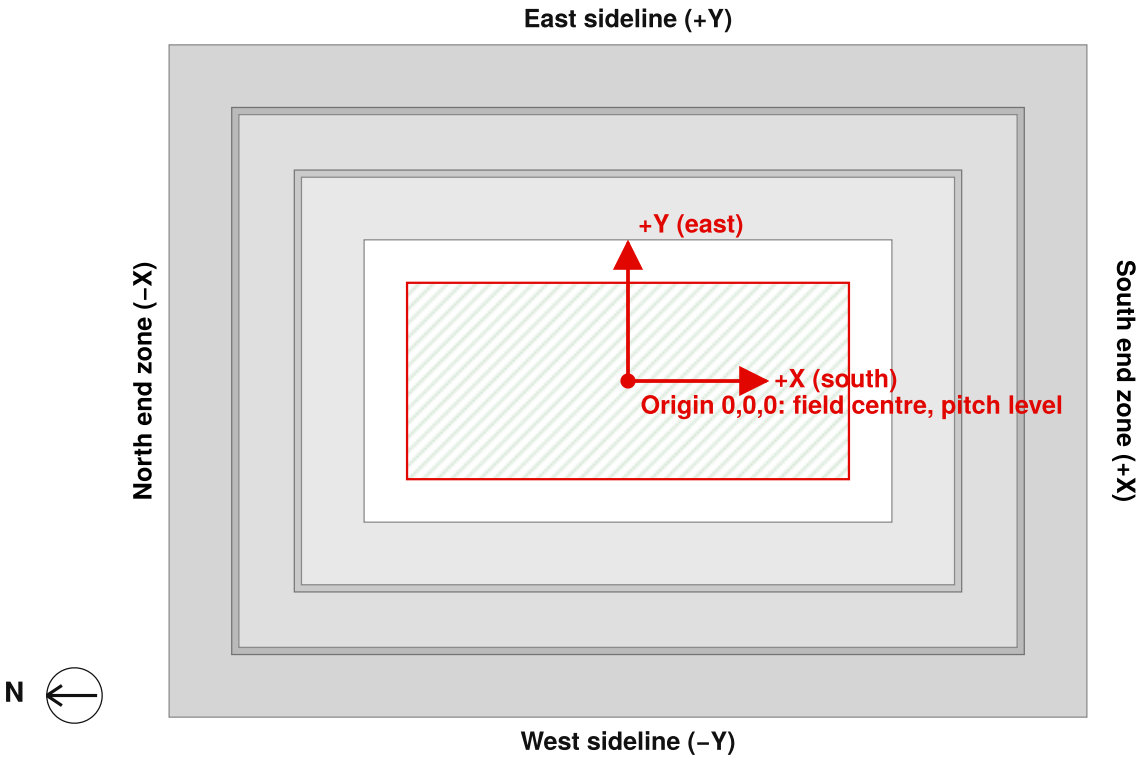
5 Check what came in

Open **Window › Default Tray › Outliner**. You will see one closed solid per stand (for example Tier 1 East sideline), the group **Aisle steps (precast)** with one component per aisle per row, and the pitch.



The same bowl in the Sightline 3D view. The SketchUp import should match it stand for stand. Open corners are gaps between stands.

6 Check orientation and size



Plan of the imported model. Origin 0,0,0 is the field centre at pitch level. The north end zone sits on −X (red axis, negative side); the East sideline on +Y (green axis).

- Use the **Tape Measure** from the field edge (the point of focus) to the Tier 1 front riser. It must match the **Sideline Depth 1** shown in Sightline (35'-0", 10.668 m, in this example).
- To put north up the green axis, select everything, use **Rotate** about the origin and turn it 90° clockwise seen from above. Or leave the model as is and set north with **Window › Default Tray › Shadows** and the Solar North tool.

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7 Use it as a mass

- Select all the stands and use **Make Group**, then give the group a Tag such as **Bowl mass**, so you can hide it or turn it grey in scenes.
- Each stand is a solid: **Entity Info** shows its volume, and the Solid Tools (Outer Shell, Intersect, Subtract) work on it.
- Hide the **Aisle steps (precast)** group for a lighter model while massing.
- Changed the bowl in Sightline? Download again and import again: delete the old groups first, or import into a new model and copy across.

IF SOMETHING LOOKS WRONG

What you see	Why, and what to do
COLLADA is not in the file type list	Use SketchUp Pro desktop. SketchUp for Web and the free plans do not import .dae files.
The bowl is 1,000 times too big or too small	The file was converted on the way. Import the original .dae from the zip; it is in metres.
The bowl is not on the origin	It was dropped where you clicked. Use **Move** from the centre of the pitch to the origin, or import again with Preserve drawing origin ticked.
Faces look dark or see-through	Some faces show their back side. Select the stand, right-click, **Reverse Faces**, or use **Orient Faces**.

Sightline Schematic 2026.11.05.03. Guide file: Stadium_Bowl_Mass_Sketchup_Guide.pdf. Menu names are for SketchUp 2024 and Revit 2024 (Dynamo 2.17); other versions may differ slightly.